

This Humanitarian Update is produced by OCHA Regional Office for the Middle East and North Africa (ROMENA) on behalf of and in collaboration with UN agencies and humanitarian organisations. It covers the period from 1 to 31 May 2026.

HIGHLIGHTS

- A temporary ceasefire announced on 7 April for an initial two-week period has subsequently been extended, although conditions remain fragile and subject to change with attacks having been reported in the area in southern Iran around the Strait of Hormuz in late May.
- Cumulative figures have been reported for the earlier period of hostilities. A total of 3,375 civilian deaths, including 383 children, 496 women¹, 67 teachers and 296 students², 27 health workers³, 5 nurses⁴, and more than 33,000⁵ injuries have been reported.
- Four rescue workers of the Iranian Red Crescent Society have been reported killed and more than 60 injured.⁶
- Educational facilities sustained severe damages with 1,726 educational and affiliated facilities affected including 1,507 schools.⁷ As for cultural sites, damage has been reported in 149 historical sites across 18 provinces, including 54 museums, 7 historic areas, and 5 World Heritage sites. Tehran sustained the highest number of damages with 70 sites impacted.⁸
- Over 149,000 civilian infrastructures were hit by 2,138 airstrikes across most provinces⁹, including 51,000 homes damaged only in Tehran.¹⁰ More than 50 points of road and rail routes -including highways, tunnels, and bridges—were targeted.¹¹
- Out of 2,138 attacks between 28 February and 10 April, Tehran sustained the majority of attacks (522) followed by Hormozgan (177), Khuzestan (151), Isfahan (148), Bushehr (111), East Azerbaijan (109), and Fars (107). The remaining provinces experienced fewer than 100 incidents of attacks, while North Khorasan was the only province reportedly not attacked.¹²



Source: OCHA. The boundaries and names shown and the designations used on this map do not imply official endorsement or acceptance by the United Nations.

¹ [Fars News, 24 May 2026.](#)

² [ISNA News Agency, 10 May 2026.](#)

³ [ISNA News Agency, 19 May 2026.](#)

⁴ [IRNA News Agency, 18 May 2026.](#)

⁵ [Fars News, 24 May 2026.](#)

⁶ [Iranian Red Crescent Society, 20 May 2026.](#)

⁷ [IRNA News Agency, 25 May 2026.](#)

⁸ [IRNA News Agency, 17 May 2026.](#)

⁹ [Iranian Red Crescent Society, 13 May 2026.](#)

¹⁰ [Asr Iran News, 20 May 2026.](#)

¹¹ [Mehr News Agency, 31 May 2026.](#)

¹² [Iranian Red Crescent Society, 13 May 2026.](#)

KEY FIGURES



3.3K+

Civilians killed¹³



33K+

Civilians injured¹⁴



3.8M+

People impacted¹⁵



149K+

Civilian units damaged¹⁶

SITUATION OVERVIEW

Cumulative figures continue to be reported on the earlier period of hostilities (28 February – 10 April). In May, authorities reported at least 383 children and 496 women among those killed (at least 3,375 people), and over 33,000 injuries.¹⁷ Critical infrastructure has been heavily impacted, including 245 health facilities¹⁸, more than 1,500 schools¹⁹, about 400 water-related sites.²⁰ The Iranian Red Crescent Society (IRCS) reported damage to 149,528 civilian infrastructures including 123,647 residential and 24,450 commercial units, 32 universities, 56 Red Crescent centres, 43 ambulances, 49 rescue vehicles, three operational vehicles, and three Red Crescent and emergency helicopters. The number of 15 critical infrastructures, five fuel depots, 15 airports²¹, and 211 stadiums and sports facilities²² were targeted. Several power plants serving industrial units were damaged, requiring the compensation of the shortfall using other available capacities.²³ Reports indicate that over 500 communication sites were targeted causing damage estimated at nearly US \$335 million in the Information Technology (IT) sector.²⁴ Further, Iran's scientific and research infrastructure including knowledge-based companies sustained an estimated \$330 millions in damage.²⁵ A recent study found that airstrikes on 7 March released 29,800 tons of toxic sulfur dioxide over Tehran, comparable to several days of emissions from Hawaii's volcano.²⁶

¹³ WHO Situation Report #8, Middle East Conflict, 28 May (figures are for the period 28 February – 27 May).

¹⁴ WHO Situation Report #8, Middle East Conflict, 28 May (figures are for the period 28 February – 27 May).

¹⁵ Estimation based on an analysis combining public data on strike locations with population data sets, of people living within a 500m-radius of reported impact zones from 28 February and as of 30 March 2026.

¹⁶ Iranian Red Crescent Society, 13 May 2026.

¹⁷ [Fars News Agency, 24 May 2026.](#)

¹⁸ [IRNA News Agency, 12 May 2026.](#)

¹⁹ [IRNA News Agency, 25 May 2026.](#)

²⁰ [Fararu News, 12 May 2026.](#)

²¹ [Iranian Red Crescent Society, 13 May 2026.](#)

²² [IRNA News Agency, 29 May 2026.](#)

²³ [ANA News Agency, 9 May 2026.](#)

²⁴ [IRNA News Agency, 9 May 2026.](#)

²⁵ [Khabaronline News, 23 May 2026.](#)

²⁶ [Asr Iran News, 30 May 2026.](#)

Although a ceasefire is in place, humanitarian conditions continue to deteriorate due to inflation and economic disruption, with food inflation reaching up to 115 per cent, severely limiting household purchasing power and increasing vulnerability.

With public order remaining largely stable since ceasefire, increasing numbers of people are likely returning to their places of habitual residence following the large movement in March. However, the humanitarian situation is driven by a combination of repercussions of temporary relocation, infrastructure damage, economic decline, high inflation and reduced household purchasing power across affected and vulnerable groups including refugees, women, children, and persons with disabilities. The most critical needs relate to access to health services, mental support, safe water, food, protection, shelter, cash assistance, and education.

HUMANITARIAN IMPACT AND NEEDS

Health

The health system has sustained significant damage, with approximately 245 health facilities and 90 pharmaceutical facilities damaged, alongside reported shortages of nearly 1,000 types of medicines and rising prices of some medicines. The most affected provinces in terms of healthcare facilities were Kermanshah, Isfahan, Ilam, Kordestan, Hormozgan, and Tehran. More than 6,000 locations and 2,000 operational zones within Iran's electricity industry were indirectly affected by airstrikes causing widespread damage across the country's power infrastructure.²⁷ This has worsened electricity imbalance and caused more frequent power cuts affecting the health sector.²⁸

The health system remains under strain, even while emergency care capacity has been mobilized, including treatment for over 30,000 injured individuals, the inauguration of 160 health centres during the conflict, the provision of more than 700,000 vaccination services, and care and treatment for 20,000 patients with HIV and 6,000 patients with tuberculosis.

Additionally, mental health conditions, including anxiety, trauma, and post-traumatic stress disorder, have increased significantly among affected and vulnerable population. Urgent needs include the restoration of health service delivery through provision of medicines, vaccines, and cold chain equipment, as well as temporary facilities and mobile health services. Expanding access to health services particularly in underserved areas and scaling up mental health and psychosocial support (MHPSS) remain critical priorities.

Water, Sanitation and Hygiene

Water infrastructure has been significantly impacted, with damage reported in 388 locations. Immediate needs include emergency repair of water systems, provision of safe water through trucking and storage, and distribution of water treatment supplies. Hygiene promotion, access to sanitation facilities, and

²⁷ [IRNA News Agency, 23 May 2026.](#)

²⁸ [Fararu News, 6 May 2026.](#)

strengthened water quality monitoring are also essential to provide access to safe water and to prevent disease outbreaks.

Food Security

Food markets remain operational; however, affordability has sharply declined as the point-to-point inflation reached 73 per cent. Food and beverage inflation surpassed 112.5% nationwide with essential staples like cooking oils skyrocketing up to 375 per cent and meat costs jumping 191 per cent. This has significantly reduced household purchasing power particularly among vulnerable groups and Afghan refugees. Priority needs include the provision of emergency food assistance and expansion of cash-based transfers to enable households to meet basic needs. In parallel, support to restore livelihoods and stabilize household incomes is essential to mitigate further deterioration in food security.

Protection

Protection risks have increased across affected populations, with rising levels of psychosocial distress. Refugees, particularly Afghan nationals, face additional challenges related to documentation requirements required for basic services such as health insurance that is dependent on financial capacity and access to reliable information. Economic hardship combined with conflict-related stress is also contributing to increased levels of trauma and the adoption of negative coping mechanisms. Key priorities include scaling up targeted cash assistance to vulnerable groups, strengthening legal assistance and documentation support, and expanding community-based protection mechanisms. There is also a critical need to increase access to MHPSS services to address widespread trauma and mental health needs.

Education

The education sector has experienced extensive loss and disruption. It has been reported that a total of 346 individuals from the education community, including 67 teachers and 279 students, lost their lives. In addition, more than 200 teachers and students were injured, highlighting the direct human toll of the conflict on the education sector. National authorities reported that about 1,500 educational facilities including 1,288 schools sustained damage between 20% and 100%, with 16 schools completely destroyed primarily located in Tehran, Markazi, and Hormozgan provinces.²⁹ Immediate needs include rehabilitation and reconstruction of damaged schools, provision of learning materials and connectivity support, and establishment of alternative learning arrangements. Additionally, psychosocial support for students and teachers is essential to address the significant emotional impacts of the crisis.

Shelter and Non-Food Items

The destruction of homes and loss of essential household items further exacerbate vulnerabilities. Key needs include the provision of emergency shelter solutions, distribution of non-food items, and cash assistance to support rental costs and housing recovery. Tehran Municipality reported that nearly 40,000 units required minor repairs in the capital, and have been almost completed.³⁰ Authorities deployed

²⁹ [ISNA News Agency, 10 May 2026.](#)

³⁰ [IRNA News Agency, 16 May 2026.](#)

1,500 experts across 24 provinces, enabling rapid repairs, with over 30,000 housing units restored largely through minor fixes.³¹

Emergency Livelihoods

The conflict has had a severe impact on livelihoods, particularly due to disruptions in businesses, industries, and income-generating activities. Authorities reported that around 3,000 industrial facilities of various sizes suffered damage.³² An estimated total of 512 industrial units were directly or indirectly damaged only in Tehran Province.³³ There is a need to strengthening liquidity and resilience to help businesses resume functioning and contribution to local economic stability. Livelihood recovery efforts are essential to restore economic activity and reduce long-term dependency on humanitarian aid namely among refugee and most vulnerable populations.

RESPONSE

Health

Despite water and wastewater infrastructure damage and the emergence of epidemics in some parts of the country, the outbreaks were successfully controlled through daily monitoring by the Ministry of Health and Medical Education. While population movements were high in some provinces during the conflict, access to health services was maintained, and even in densely populated areas, access to communicable disease control services was ensured.³⁴ National Health partners have provided emergency care to more than 40,000 patients, including over 1,300 surgical procedures, while continuing to support health service delivery nationwide. Efforts include the provision of vaccines, medical supplies, and backup power systems to sustain operations in affected facilities. Mental health services have also been expanded by national partners, including mobilizing a network of 700 psychologists during the conflict for provision of support to affected people, and mental health screening for 340,000 individuals nationwide. The World Health Organisation (WHO) provided training for approximately 250 healthcare workers in 29 provinces to deliver MHPSS services. WHO is procuring power generators and UPS systems for target hospitals and strengthening outbreak control and sustains essential medical and diagnostic supplies and laboratory equipment. The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) is procuring emergency backup generators to provincial cold chain warehouses, hospitals, and primary health facilities to safeguard vaccine and medicine cold chain functionality and continuity of essential services.

Water, Sanitation and Hygiene

Repair and reconstruction operations of the damaged water infrastructure have been implemented by local organizations. The United Nations Agency for Children (UNICEF) supported water quality monitoring and safe water storage and purification from its prepositioned Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH) emergency stocks. The distribution of 4,300 hygiene kits of different kinds through a national NGO was completed in three affected provinces. In parallel, additional support in safe water provision,

³¹ [IRNA News Agency, 16 May 2026.](#)

³² [EGHTESADONLINE, 23 May 2026.](#)

³³ [IRNA News Agency, 30 May 2026.](#)

³⁴

storage, and monitoring, personal hygiene, and environmental sanitation is on the way. UNDP is supporting the provision of emergency chlorination and disinfection units to restore water treatment functionality, supporting emergency restoration of priority pumping capacity, and deploying temporary water storage tanks and towable water tankers to sustain supply in affected communities. Small-scale reverse osmosis desalination units are being deployed in areas dependent on brackish groundwater.

Food Security

National organizations provided 188,000 malnourished children with free monthly food basket credits since the beginning of the current Iranian year (21 March 2026) through the national e-voucher system to purchase approved food items at participating stores.³⁵

The World Food Programme (WFP) is procuring food packages in collaboration with the Iranian Red Crescent Society and has provided assistance to 34,818 refugees through food and cash support. Current interventions include daily bread through WFP-supported bakeries and distribution of wheat flour, emergency food packages, school feeding items, and cash-based transfers.

Protection

National partners provided support to more than 40,000 individuals living directly in conflict-affected areas through cash and in-kind assistance such as livelihood packages, medical expenses, housing repair, and relief packages.³⁶ About 1,200 vulnerable and high-risk elderly individuals living alone were identified and received necessary services.³⁷ The International Organisation for Migration (IOM) provided cash assistance to 410 households, reaching 1,987 individuals (including multipurpose cash, cash for protection, and cash for health), targeting vulnerable migrants and host community members. UNICEF in collaboration with local partners conducted a one-day technical booster session on the Adolescent Wellbeing Kit for 14 facilitators following a three-day training workshop. UNICEF further supported MHPSS for general population in Minab city (Hormozgan Province), where 50 mental health professionals were trained along with technical sessions for a group of supervisors. The Norwegian Refugee Council (NRC) is providing a comprehensive package of support addressing protection needs and associated risks. NRC supported cash and non-cash assistance (such as wheelchairs) for individuals at risk of deprivation.

Education

Education partners are supporting continuity of learning through online local platforms, offline learning and educational packages, and television-based education, and have initiated rehabilitation activities, with above 1,000 schools already repaired and prepared for use. NRC secured funding to support light to medium rehabilitation of classrooms damaged by blast waves with preparatory activities ongoing including the identification of target schools. NRC is also supporting the provision of offline learning materials, lesson plans, and study guides. The United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation (UNESCO) secured fund from its headquarters to support the provision of psychosocial assistance to children affected by the recent escalation, in collaboration with national partners.

³⁵ [IRNA News Agency, 8 May 2026.](#)

³⁶ [ILNA News Agency, 9 May 2026.](#)

³⁷ [KHABARONLINE, 19 May 2026.](#)

Shelter and Non-Food Items

UNICEF completed the distribution of 2,900 Rapid Response Kits in Tehran, Hormozgan, Khuzestan, and Bushehr provinces to vulnerable households affected by recent conflict-related displacement and service disruption.

Early Recovery

National partners reported that 1,230 urban service teams, supported by over 2,030 machines, were deployed for debris removal and road clearance following the destructions caused by strikes.³⁸ UNDP procured wheel loaders, excavators and the low-bed trailers and delivered to local partners. Procurement of the medical evacuation kits and more equipment is ongoing. Early recovery interventions are underway, focusing on debris clearance, restoration of access to markets and services, and livelihood recovery. Efforts also include support to small businesses and assessments to inform recovery programming. However, progress remains constrained by economic instability, infrastructure damage, and ongoing connectivity disruptions. UNESCO is working on a pipeline proposal to support the recovery and restoration of conflict-affected cultural heritage sites and is mobilizing heritage emergency funding mechanisms to strengthen preparedness and response capacities across the broader museums and cultural heritage sector, with the objective of enhancing systemic resilience and improving readiness for future crises.

³⁸ [IRNA News Agency, 8 May 2026](#).